Australia and Wars

World War I broke out and caused destruction in Australia during the early 20th century. By 1914, Australia had a population of about 3,000,000 men of which 420,000 volunteered to fight. Historians estimate that 60,000 men died and several thousand were wounded in the war. After the war, the government initiated the Soldier Settler Scheme which presented compensation and farmland to war veterans.

With the Roaring Twenties, importing of cars, jazz music and movies, the Australian community began to love anything that was British in origin. At the end of the 1920s, the Great Depression occurred causing numerous financial organizations to collapse and the gap between the wealthy and the poor to become wider. The people turned to sports such as sailing and cricket to forget the negativity the country was experiencing.